Figurative Language (Set B)

Year 4 · **Lesson Worksheet**

Worked Examples

Example 1: Identify the figurative device: 'The clock's hands crawled slowly around its face.'

Answer: Personification — the clock is given the human-like ability to 'crawl'.

Example 2: Identify the figurative device: 'Her smile was a ray of sunshine.'

Answer: Metaphor — her smile is directly described AS a ray of sunshine, without using 'like' or 'as'.

Example 3: What does the idiom 'to let the cat out of the bag' mean?

Answer: To accidentally reveal a secret.

Core Practice (15 questions)

1. Identify the figurative device: "The wind howled through the trees."
2. Identify the figurative device: "Her eyes sparkled like diamonds."
3. Identify the figurative device: "Busy bees buzzed by the blossoms."
4. Identify the figurative device: "The bacon sizzled in the pan."
5. Which type of figurative language is used in "He is as brave as a lion"? A) metaphor B) simile C) personification D) onomatopoeia E) alliteration
6. Which type of figurative language is used in "Time is money"? A) simile B) metaphor C) alliteration D) idiom E) onomatopoeia
7. Identify the figurative device: "The leaves danced in the breeze."
8. What does the idiom "break the ice" mean? A) To end an argument angrily B) To cause something to freeze C) To do or say something to relieve tension or start a conversation D) To break something made of ice E) To ignore someone
9. Which word in this sentence is an example of onomatopoeia: "The balloon went pop and the children laughed"?
10. Select ALL the sentences below that contain a simile. A) "She runs like the wind." B) "The sun smiled down on us." C) "He is as cunning as a fox." D) "The waves crashed loudly." E) "Snow blanketed the fields."
11. Identify the figurative device: "Six silly sisters sold seashells."
12. What does the idiom "spill the beans" mean?
13. Identify the figurative device: "The storm was a raging monster."
14. Which type of figurative language is used in "The bees buzzed and the bacon sizzled"? A) simile B) onomatopoeia C) alliteration D) metaphor E) idiom
15. Identify the figurative device: "The moon winked at the stars."

Applied Practice (15 questions)

1. Explain the meaning created by the simile: "The classroom was as silent as a graveyard."

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2. Explain the meaning created by the metaphor: "His words were daggers, cutting deep."
3. Identify the TWO figurative devices used in: "The thunder grumbled overhead like an angry giant," and explain each briefly.
4. What does the idiom "the ball is in your court" mean?
5. Which type of figurative language is used in "The silver stream slithered silently through the sleepy village"? A) onomatopoeia B) alliteration C) metaphor D) idiom E) simile
6. Choose the best interpretation of the idiom "bite off more than you can chew" in: "He signed up for three clubs, two sports teams and a part-time job — he'd clearly bitten off more than he could chew." A) He ate too much food B) He took on more responsibilities than he could manage C) He chewed loudly D) He was very hungry E) He enjoyed a large meal
7. Identify the figurative device: "The old floorboards groaned under his feet."
8. Write a simile of your own to describe someone moving very slowly.
9. Write a metaphor of your own to describe a classroom full of noisy children.
10. Select ALL the sentences below that contain personification. A) "The wind whispered secrets through the trees." B) "She is as quick as a cheetah." C) "The old house groaned and creaked." D) "Rain is nature's tears." E) "The flowers nodded in the breeze."
11. What does the idiom "once in a blue moon" mean?
12. Explain why "The snow was a soft white blanket" is a metaphor and not a simile.
13. Identify the figurative device: "Crash! Bang! Went the falling shelves."
14. Which idiom best completes: "I was so nervous before my exam, I had ___ in my stomach." A) butterflies B) spiders C) bees D) frogs E) ants
15. Choose the best interpretation of "The news hit her like a ton of bricks." A) The news was physically heavy B) The news was delivered slowly C) The news shocked and overwhelmed her suddenly D) The news was about construction E) The news made her laugh

Challenge (15 questions)

1. Explain why the metaphor 'Life is a rollercoaster' works well to describe life's ups and downs.
2. Select ALL the devices present in 'The fierce fire roared through the forest.' A) Alliteration B) Simile C) Personification D) Onomatopoeia
3. What is the difference between a simile and a metaphor? Give one original example of each.
4. Which best explains why a writer might use personification instead of a plain description? A) To make the writing shorter B) To make non-human things feel alive or relatable C) To confuse the reader D) To avoid using adjectives
5. Explain the meaning of the idiom 'actions speak louder than words', giving one example of when you might use it.
6. Identify the figurative device: 'The computer screen stared blankly back at him.'
7. Give one idiom that means 'to keep a secret'.
8. Identify the figurative device used, and explain its effect: 'The city never sleeps.'
9. Which idiom best fits: 'After months of training, she finally felt ready to ___ and compete.' A) hit the nail on the head B) take the bull by the horns C) let sleeping dogs lie D) cry over spilt milk

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10. Explain why 'The silence was deafening' works as a figurative description, even though silence cannot literally be loud.

11. Identify the figurative device: 'Opportunity knocked at his door.'

12. Select ALL the sentences below that use BOTH a simile and personification. A) 'The old oak tree stretched its branches like weary arms.' B) 'She sang like an angel.' C) 'The wind howled like a wolf through the house.' D) 'The stars twinkled brightly.'

13. Write an original extended metaphor (2 sentences) comparing a tricky exam to climbing a mountain.

14. Choose the sentence where the idiom is used with the WRONG meaning. A) 'She was over the moon when she won the prize.' B) 'He let the cat out of the bag by revealing the surprise early.' C) 'He was on cloud nine after failing his test.' D) 'They were on the same page about the plan.'

15. Explain what the repeated sound adds in 'Peter Piper picked a peck of pickled peppers', beyond just being fun to say.

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